

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
FOR

HOUSE BILL NO. 2210

By: Lay

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

An Act relating to career and technology education; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-127, which relates to youth apprenticeship programs; modifying the applicable age range; detailing when high school students may begin the program; directing the Department of Career and Technology Education to oversee and implement the program; requiring apprenticeship coordinators and describing their duties; defining and requiring workplace mentors; granting oversight to the Secretary of Education; requiring certain reports; appropriating funds to carry out the program; providing for noncodification; and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-127, is amended to read as follows:

Section 14-127. A. The Oklahoma Legislature, recognizing the need for improved methods of helping ~~secondary students~~ youth sixteen (16) to twenty-five (25) years of age make a ~~smooth~~ meaningful transition from high school to the workplace, hereby establishes guidelines for youth apprenticeship programs. It shall

1 be the responsibility of the Oklahoma Department of Career and
2 Technology Education to establish a state-certified apprenticeship
3 program. The Board shall establish the rules to carry out the state
4 apprenticeship program.

5 B. Youth apprenticeship programs shall be defined as learning
6 programs for young people enrolled in vocational education that
7 combine ~~on-the-job~~ work-based learning with classroom instruction,
8 that offer a bridge between secondary and post high school training
9 and education, and that result in certification of mastery of work
10 skills.

11 C. A high school student may begin participation in an
12 apprenticeship beginning in the eleventh grade. Students who do not
13 begin participation during the eleventh grade may enter a pre-
14 apprenticeship or a full apprenticeship during the twelfth grade,
15 subject to employer need and program design. Students must be at
16 least sixteen (16) years of age to begin paid employment at a
17 workplace but related instruction may be completed before a student
18 turns sixteen (16) years of age. High school students who enter an
19 Oklahoma-certified apprenticeship program shall be given equal
20 credit to an Oklahoma CareerTech-approved full-time postsecondary
21 program.

22 D. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education
23 shall fund apprenticeship coordinators. Apprenticeship coordinators
24 shall serve as the main liaison among school districts, industry

1 consortia, and hosting employers. Apprenticeship coordinators shall
2 also be responsible for guiding apprenticeship approval, providing
3 technical assistance to employers, site-based mentors, and school
4 districts, collecting site-level data on approved apprenticeships,
5 forming industry consortia, and chairing semi-annual industry
6 consortia meetings. Apprenticeship coordinators shall have a
7 caseload of apprenticeships to manage at their sites. After the
8 first year of operation, Oklahoma Department of Career and
9 Technology Education may move apprenticeship coordinators based on
10 varying local capacity for apprenticeships. The Oklahoma Department
11 of Career and Technology Education shall work to ensure that
12 apprenticeship opportunities are comparable in rural, suburban, and
13 urban areas.

14 E. A "workplace mentor" refers to an experienced employee who
15 provides direct supervision, instruction, and support for high
16 school apprentices, ensuring that an apprentice receives the skills
17 needed for a recognized credential and a clear pathway to full-time
18 employment in a skilled occupation. Each high school apprenticeship
19 shall have a site-based mentor.

20 F. The Secretary of Education shall provide statewide oversight
21 of all Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education-
22 approved high school apprenticeship programs. An annual report
23 shall be submitted to the Legislature that includes, but is not
24 limited to, the number of high school apprenticeships currently

1 enrolled, the number of high school apprenticeships completed, the
2 estimated return on investment of completed apprenticeships to the
3 state, and capacity differences across rural, suburban, and urban
4 areas of the state.

5 G. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education
6 shall contract with an Oklahoma-based external evaluator or
7 Oklahoma-based university researcher to conduct a comprehensive
8 return on investment and impact evaluation of approved high school
9 apprenticeship programs. This report shall be submitted to the
10 Secretary of Education annually to inform the Secretary of
11 Education's annual report to the Legislature. This external
12 evaluation will be used to make annual funding determinations. The
13 cost of the evaluation shall not exceed Twelve Thousand Dollars
14 (\$12,000.00).

15 H. Youth apprenticeship programs shall be administered and
16 supervised by the State Board of Career and Technology Education,
17 which shall also establish standards for program operation.

18 ~~D.~~ I. Notwithstanding any other section of law, youth
19 apprenticeship programs shall not mean any traditional
20 apprenticeship program registered by the Bureau of Apprenticeship
21 and Training, United States Department of Labor.

22 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law not to be
23 codified in the Oklahoma Statutes reads as follows:
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1 There is hereby appropriated to the Oklahoma Department of
2 Career and Technology Education from any monies not otherwise
3 appropriated from the General Fund of the State Treasury for the
4 fiscal year ending June 30, 2027, the sum of Two Million Dollars
5 (\$2,000,000.00) or so much thereof as may be necessary to perform
6 the duties imposed upon the Oklahoma Department of Career and
7 Technology to carry out the youth apprenticeship program as directed
8 in Section 1 of this act.

9 SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

10 SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
11 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
12 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
13 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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